

NET731 – Cloud Networking

Week 8 Practical: Cost Management

24 – 30 April 2026

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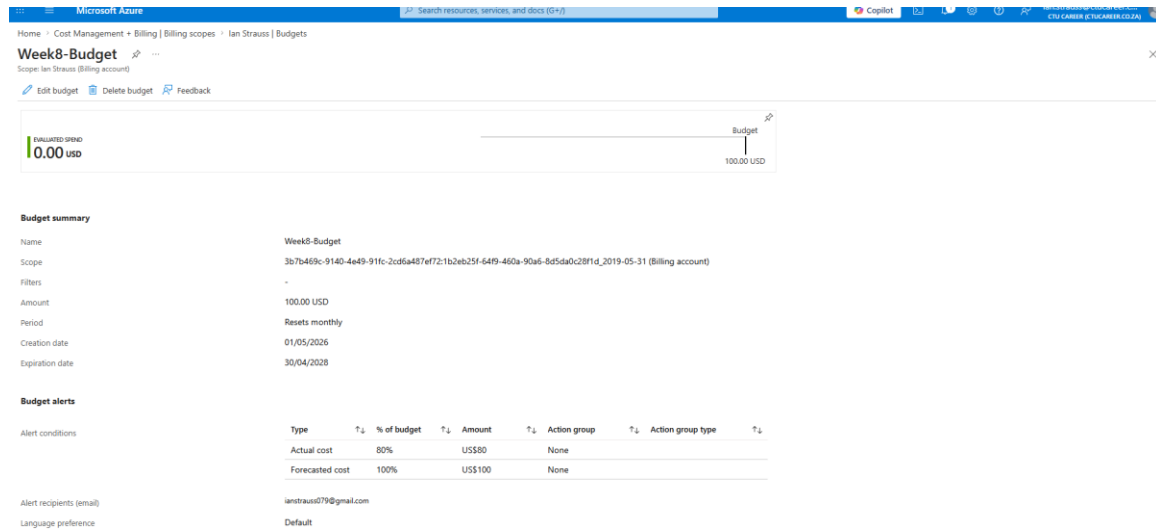
Student Number: 20240049

Task 1: Azure Budget Alerts

Setting	Value
Budget Name	Week8-Budget
Scope	Azure Subscription
Budget Amount	\$100
Time Period	Monthly
Alert Threshold 1	80% Actual Spend
Alert Threshold 2	100% Forecasted Spend
Alert Email	Your student email

A budget was created in Azure Cost Management to monitor cloud spending and ensure that project costs remain within the allocated \$100 limit. Two alert thresholds were configured to provide warnings before the budget is exceeded.

Screenshot Evidence – Budget Configuration



Task 2: Cost Analysis and Resource Optimisation

Azure Cost Analysis was used to review spending by Resource, Resource Group, and Service Name to identify the highest-cost resources.

Top Cost Resources

Virtual Machine

The virtual machine was one of the highest-cost resources because compute charges continue while the VM is running.

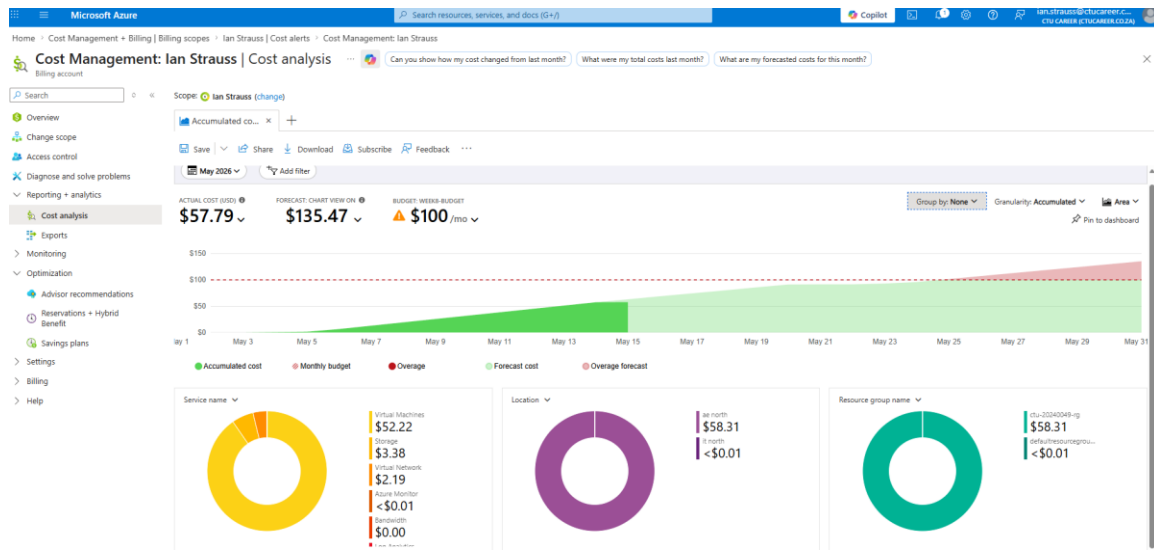
Storage Account

Storage costs were generated from VM disks, storage usage, and diagnostics logs.

Public IP Address

Public IP resources can still generate charges while allocated to resources.

Screenshot Evidence – Cost Analysis



Resource Optimisation Changes

The virtual machine was stopped and deallocated to reduce unnecessary compute charges while not in use. This helps reduce monthly cloud spending and keeps the subscription within the allocated budget.

Projected Monthly Spend

Based on the current spending trend and optimisation changes made, the projected monthly spend is estimated to remain below the \$100 budget limit.

Estimated projected spend: \$40 – \$50

Recommendations for Future Students

- Stop virtual machines when not in use.
- Use smaller VM sizes for testing environments.
- Monitor Azure Cost Analysis regularly.
- Remove unused resources such as disks and public IP addresses.
- Configure budget alerts early in the project.

Reflection Questions

1. What surprised you most about your Azure spending this week?

I was surprised by how quickly virtual machine costs increase when resources are left running continuously. Even small resources contribute to the total subscription cost.

2. How would cost management differ in a production environment used by a real business?

A production environment would require stricter monitoring, automated scaling, and continuous availability while still controlling operational costs. Businesses would also need detailed reporting and governance policies.

3. What additional Azure Cost Management features would you explore if you had more time?

I would explore Azure Advisor recommendations, reserved instances, forecasting tools, and automated cost alerts to improve long-term cloud cost optimisation.

GitHub Submission

Commit message example:

```
git commit -m "Added Week 8 Azure cost management practical"
```

Submission Checklist

- ☒ Budget configured in Azure
- ☒ Budget screenshots captured

- ☒ Cost analysis reviewed
- ☒ Resource optimisation completed
- ☒ cost-report.md created
- ☒ Screenshots uploaded to GitHub
- ☒ Reflection questions answered
- ☒ Changes committed and pushed to GitHub